

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

difficult. The whole concept of advertising and marketing is finding ways to get you to part with your cash in the most cost-effective way possible, and companies are not shy about manipulating your emotions in order to do that. Although I do have some insider knowledge of the kind of targeting that goes on, having worked in brands and marketing in a previous life, you really only have to watch a single episode of *Mad Men* to gain a basic understanding of how it all works. We are all boiling pots of emotions, ready to spew out our credit card details if tapped in the right place. I won't go as far as to say that advertising should be banned, because it is really just a by-product of the capitalist society that we live in, and is a gigantic industry in itself, employing a lot of people and putting food on the table for a lot of households. But it's also a very big factor in our financial wellbeing, and we need to take it into consideration when we look more closely at our spending behaviour and what we can do to ensure that we're not being manipulated into using shopping as a way to process our emotions. Building resilience to some of the techniques used, like FOMO and comparison, as well as gaining a greater understanding of why we respond the way that we do to certain stimuli, will enable you to feel more in control of your spending and promote better financial wellbeing.

In order to make sure that we're practising mindful spending most of the time, we also need to tap into some of the internal work that we covered in Steps One and Two – the feeling of being enough without sacrificing everything to please others,